

GitHub launches new features and updates

GitHub has announced various new features and updates in its online Satellite 2020 event. These include GitHub Codespaces, GitHub Discussions, code scanning, secret scanning and GitHub Private Instances.

GitHub said that GitHub Codespaces is a complete dev environment within GitHub that lets developers contribute immediately. It said that every repository has its own way of configuring a dev environment, which often requires dozens of steps before developers can write any code. Sometimes, the environments of the two projects they are working on, conflict with one another.

GitHub Codespaces will give developers a fully-featured cloud-hosted dev environment that spins up in seconds directly within GitHub, company sources claim. Codespaces can be configured by developers to load their code and dependencies, developer tools, extensions, and dotfiles. The company said that switching between the environments has also been made simple and can be navigated at any time. And when switched back, the codespace is automatically reopened.

Codespaces in GitHub includes a browser based version of the full VS code editor. It has support for code completion and navigation, extensions, terminal access, etc. If developers prefer to use their desktop IDE, they will be able to start a codespace in GitHub and connect to it from their desktop.

GitHub said that it has not finalised the pricing for Codespaces but also mentioned that the code-editing functionality in the codespaces IDE will always be free. GitHub plans to offer simple pay-as-you-go pricing similar to GitHub Actions for computationally intensive tasks such as builds. During the beta phase, Codespaces is free.

cross-section of European companies and governmental organisations to open source projects will be crucial to ensure that these emerging technologies are fit for Europe. These contributions will also need to see whether these technologies have been designed with due consideration to the privacy and security of individuals and organisations, as well as to the environment.

Juergen Mueller, chief technology officer and member of the executive board of SAP SE said, "The Eclipse Foundation has a long track record of fostering industry collaboration between global organisations and developers who share the goal of creating scalable open source software. As a founding strategic member of the Eclipse Foundation, SAP actively participates in several Eclipse projects and working groups. With the legal move of the Eclipse Foundation to Brussels, we expect more international collaboration across industries in an open environment. We look forward to collaborating with members from around the world to create and innovate together."

Mozilla announces first three recipients of COVID-19 Solutions Fund

Mozilla has announced the first three COVID-19 Solutions Fund recipients. A



month back, it had announced the creation of a COVID-19 Solutions Fund as part of the Mozilla Open Source Support Program (MOSS). It aimed to provide awards of up to US\$ 50,000 each to open source technology projects working towards reducing the spread of the COVID-19 pandemic in some way. The first three recipients

include VentMon, created by Public Invention in Austin, Texas; Recidiviz based in the Bay area, and 3DBrooklyn for the COVID-19 Supplies NYC project.

VentMon can be used for testing of ventilator designs before deployment and for ICU patient monitoring. The makers received a US\$ 20,000 award, which will enable them to buy parts for the VentMon to support more than 20 open source engineering teams trying to build ventilators.

Recidiviz is a tech non-profit that has built a modelling tool which helps prison administrators and government officials forecast the impact of COVID-19 on their prisons and jails. The data equips them to assess changes they can make to slow the spread, such as reducing the density in prison populations or granting early release to people who are deemed to pose a low risk to public safety. The MOSS committee approved a US\$ 50,000 award for this recipient. Recidiviz's tool was downloaded by 47 states within 48 hours of launch.

ScyllaDB releases Scylla Open Source 4.0

ScyllaDB has announced the release of Scylla Open Source 4.0, a NoSQL database for real-time Big Data workloads. The company said that Scylla has moved beyond feature parity with Apache Cassandra. It is now serving as an open source drop-in, no-lock-in alternative to Amazon DynamoDB.

Scylla Open Source 4.0 builds on Scylla's close-to-the-hardware design. The company said that it is written from the ground-up in C++ and delivers a performance of millions of OPS on a single node. It scales out to hundreds of nodes, and consistently achieves a 99 per cent tail latency of less than one millisecond.

Dor Laor, CEO and co-founder, ScyllaDB said, "Scylla 4.0 is our largest release ever, with improvements ranging from ease-of-use to new APIs, functionality and